at several steps and as a result many reduced coenzymes NADH + H^+ and $FADH_2$ are produced. These reduced coenzymes are transported to inner membrane of mitochondria and are converted back to their oxidised forms produce electrons and protons. In mitochondria, the inner membrane is folded in the form of finger projections towards the matrix called cristae. In cristae many oxysomes (F_1 particles) are present which have electron transport carriers. According to **Peter Mitchell's Chemiosmotic theory** this electron transport is coupled to ATP synthesis. Electron and hydrogen(proton) transport takes place across four multiprotein complexes(I-IV). They are



1. Complex-I (NADH dehydrogenase). It contains a flavoprotein(FMN) and associated with non-heme iron Sulphur protein (Fe-S). This complex is responsible for passing electrons and protons from mitochondrial NADH (**Internal)** to Ubiquinone (UQ).

$$NADH + H^+ + UQ \rightleftharpoons NAD^+ + UQH_2$$

In plants, an additional NADH dehydrogenase (**External)** complex is present on the outer surface of inner membrane of mitochondria which can oxidise cytosolic NADH + H^+. Because mitochondrial inner membrane cannot allow NADH molecules directly into the matrix.

Ubiquinone (UQ) or Coenzyme Quinone (CoQ) is a small, lipid soluble electron, proton carrier located within the inner membrane of mitochondria.

2. Complex-II (Succinic dehydrogenase) It contains FAD flavoprotein is associated with non-heme iron Sulphur (Fe-S) protein. This complex receives electrons and protons from succinate in Krebs cycle and is converted into fumarate and passes to ubiquinone.

$$Succinate + UQ \rightarrow Fumarate + UQH_2$$

3. Complex-III (Cytochrome bc_1 complex) This complex oxidises reduced ubiquinone (ubiquinol) and transfers the electrons through Cytochrome bc_1 Complex (Iron Sulphur center bc_1 complex) to cytochrome c. Cytochrome c is a small protein attached to the outer surface of inner membrane and act as a mobile carrier to transfer electrons between complex III to complex IV.

$$UQH_2 + 2Cyt\ c_{oxidised} \rightleftharpoons UQ + 2Cyt\ c_{reduced} + 2H^+$$



Ubiquinone and cytochrome bc_1 complex are structurally and functionally similar to plastoquinone and cytochrome b_6f complex respectively in the photosynthetic electron transport chain.

4. Complex IV (Cytochome c oxidase)
This complex contains two copper centers (A and B) and cytochromes a and a_3. Complex IV is the terminal oxidase and brings about the reduction of 1/2 O_2 to H_2O. Two protons are needed to form a molecule of H_2O (terminal oxidation).

$$2Cyt\ c_{oxidised} + 2H^+ + 1/2\ O_2 \rightleftharpoons 2Cyt\ c_{reduced} + H_2O$$

The transfer of electrons from reduced coenzyme NADH to oxygen *via* complexes I to IV is coupled to the synthesis of ATP from ADP and inorganic phosphate (Pi) which is called **Oxidative phosphorylation**. The F_0F_1-ATP synthase (also called complex V) consists of F_0 and F_1. F_1 converts ADP and Pi to ATP and is attached to the matrix side of the inner membrane. F_0 is present in inner membrane and acts as a channel through which protons come into matrix.



The synthesis of glucose from certain non-carbohydrate carbon substrates such as proteins and lipids are called **gluconeogenesis.**

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